Use ChatGPT to Build a Care File a Future Team Could Pick Up

Four prompts to gather your mother's current care information, note what depends on a provider you haven't chosen, see who might help later, and keep it all in one reusable file.

Where you are

Your mother is doing fine at home, and nothing is planned. You've noticed that if a new caregiver started next month, the information they'd need is in six places and two people's heads.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can point to one file that holds what any new caregiver would need to know, with the open items clearly marked as waiting on a provider and a date that don't exist yet.

A one-page readiness file: Current care information, Where each piece lives, Depends on a future provider, Who could help later, and Review date.

Before you start

- A rough idea of where her records are: the doctor's office, a drawer, a sibling's phone.
- Her current medication list, if you have one, even if you suspect it's out of date.
- A sense of who in the family is around and what they're already carrying. Rough is fine.

PROMPT 1

Map where the information lives today

WHY THIS MATTERS

You know where most things are. The trouble is that “you know” is the storage system, and it doesn't transfer well when you're busy or away.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A brain dump of what you know about her care and where each thing is kept.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I am organizing my mother's care information in case a new caregiver is ever needed. Nothing is planned. Here is what I know and where each piece currently lives:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort this into a table with three columns: INFORMATION, WHERE IT IS NOW, and HOW CURRENT IT IS (write CURRENT, PROBABLY OLD, or DON'T KNOW). Use categories like daily routine, medications, doctors and pharmacy, allergies, mobility and equipment, likes and dislikes, and legal documents by name only. Then list what a new caregiver would commonly want to know that I have not mentioned at all. Do not invent any details to fill the gaps.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The rows marked PROBABLY OLD or DON'T KNOW. Those are the ones that get reconstructed in a crisis.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick two rows and find out this week whether they're current.

PROMPT 2

Mark what has to wait for a provider

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some of the file can be finished now. Some of it can't be finished until there is an actual provider with actual forms. Mixing the two makes the file feel permanently incomplete.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The table from the first prompt.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the care information I have organized for my mother. No provider or date has been chosen and this is not a plan to move:
>
> [PASTE THE TABLE FROM PROMPT 1]
>
> Split it into two lists. CAN BE READY NOW: things that stay true no matter who provides care, like her routine, preferences, medication list, and contacts. DEPENDS ON A FUTURE PROVIDER: things we cannot fill in until a specific provider and date exist, like admission forms, their equipment rules, or transport. For the second list, write the question we would ask the provider when the time comes. Do not suggest what kind of provider or setting she should have.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A second list made of questions, not blanks. You'll ask them all at once later instead of discovering them one by one.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put the second list at the back of the file, labeled 'ask when there's a provider.'

PROMPT 3

Check who could help, without signing anyone up

WHY THIS MATTERS

It's tempting to pencil in names now. But a brother who said “sure” at Thanksgiving may have a new job by the time anything happens. This is about possibilities, not commitments.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Names of family and friends, and what you know of each person's situation.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> If my mother ever needed a change in care, these are the people who might help with preparing for it. Here is what I know about each person's time, distance, health, and what they already handle:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES ON EACH PERSON]
>
> List the kinds of preparation work that usually come up, such as gathering records, keeping the medication list current, sorting belongings, arranging transport, and talking with Mom about changes. For each kind, note who might be a good fit and why, using only what I told you. Mark anyone who seems to be carrying a lot already. Write this as possibilities to discuss, not assignments. End with three questions I could ask the family at our next conversation.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The same name appearing in every row, and the names that don't appear at all.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Bring the three questions to a family call. Ask before you assign.

PROMPT 4

Assemble the readiness file

WHY THIS MATTERS

A file that lives in a folder on your desk gets opened. A file that lives in your memory and three email threads does not.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I have organized about my mother's care information and who could help:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Put it on one page with five headings: CURRENT CARE INFORMATION, WHERE EACH PIECE LIVES, DEPENDS ON A FUTURE PROVIDER, WHO COULD HELP LATER, and REVIEW DATE. Under REVIEW DATE, suggest how often each section should be checked and leave the date for me to fill in. Add one line at the top that says this is a readiness file, not a plan to move. Do not add anything I did not give you.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page you could update in ten minutes every few months.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put a reminder on your calendar for the review date. Then keep the file; the next step picks it up.

The file needs a center.

A readiness file points to where things are. The care interview gathers your mother's situation into one Family Care Profile, which becomes the current record you update instead of six scattered documents.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›